

**BABY-LED WEANING
MEAL PLANNER &
FOOD INTRODUCTION TRACKER**

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Always consult your pediatrician before starting solids.

BLW BASICS EXPLAINED

WHAT IS BABY-LED WEANING (BLW)?

Letting your baby self-feed from the start of solids (around 6 months). No purees, no spoon-feeding - baby picks up food!

BENEFITS:

- Develops fine motor skills and hand-eye coordination
- Baby learns to self-regulate appetite
- Reduces picky eating (exposed to textures early)
- Family eats together (same foods, modified)

SAFETY ESSENTIALS:

- Baby must sit upright independently
- Always supervise meals (never leave baby alone with food)
- Know the difference between gagging and choking
- Cut round foods (grapes, cherry tomatoes) lengthwise
- No honey until age 1, no whole nuts until age 4
- Soft enough to squish between your fingers = safe

FIRST FOOD SHAPES (for 6-month-olds):

- Finger-length strips (baby grabs with whole fist)
- Soft, mashable with gums
- Examples: avocado strips, banana, steamed sweet potato

READINESS SIGNS CHECKLIST

ALL of these must be present (usually around 6 months):

- ☐ Can sit upright with minimal support
- ☐ Has lost the tongue-thrust reflex
- ☐ Shows interest in food (reaching, watching you eat)
- ☐ Can bring objects to mouth
- ☐ Can hold head steady

NOT readiness signs (common myths):

- Waking at night (normal at any age)
- Watching you eat (curiosity, not hunger)
- Being a certain weight

MY BABY'S READINESS:

Date baby showed all signs: __/__/__

Date we started BLW: __/__/__

Pediatrician approved: Y / N Date: __/__/__

FOODS BY AGE:

6 MONTHS: Soft strips, single ingredients

7-8 MONTHS: Smaller pieces, soft combinations

9-12 MONTHS: Most family foods, modified for safety

12+ MONTHS: Almost everything (watch choking hazards)

ALLERGEN INTRODUCTION TRACKER

Introduce top allergens early (6-12 months) & often.
Give each new allergen for 3 days. Note any reactions.

Cow's milk (dairy):

Date introduced: ___/___ Form given: _____

Reaction? Y/N If yes: _____

Date re-introduced: ___/___ Ongoing? Y/N

Egg:

Date introduced: ___/___ Form given: _____

Reaction? Y/N If yes: _____

Date re-introduced: ___/___ Ongoing? Y/N

Peanut:

Date introduced: ___/___ Form given: _____

Reaction? Y/N If yes: _____

Date re-introduced: ___/___ Ongoing? Y/N

Tree nuts:

Date introduced: ___/___ Form given: _____

Reaction? Y/N If yes: _____

Date re-introduced: ___/___ Ongoing? Y/N

Wheat:

Date introduced: ___/___ Form given: _____

Reaction? Y/N If yes: _____

Date re-introduced: ___/___ Ongoing? Y/N

Soy:

Date introduced: ___/___ Form given: _____

Reaction? Y/N If yes: _____

Date re-introduced: ___/___ Ongoing? Y/N

Fish:

Date introduced: ___/___ Form given: _____

Reaction? Y/N If yes: _____

Date re-introduced: ___/___ Ongoing? Y/N

Shellfish:

Date introduced: ___/___ Form given: _____

Reaction? Y/N If yes: _____

Date re-introduced: ___/___ Ongoing? Y/N

Sesame:

Date introduced: ___/___ Form given: _____

Reaction? Y/N If yes: _____

Date re-introduced: ___/___ Ongoing? Y/N

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 1-3

DAY 1 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 2 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 3 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 4-6

DAY 4 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 5 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 6 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 7-9

DAY 7 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 8 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 9 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 10-12

DAY 10 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 11 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 12 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 13-15

DAY 13 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 14 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 15 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 16-18

DAY 16 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 17 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 18 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 19-21

DAY 19 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 20 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 21 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 22-24

DAY 22 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 23 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 24 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 25-27

DAY 25 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 26 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 27 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 28-30

DAY 28 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 29 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 30 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 31-33

DAY 31 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 32 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 33 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 34-36

DAY 34 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 35 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 36 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 37-39

DAY 37 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 38 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 39 Date: ____/____/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 40-42

DAY 40 Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 41 Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 42 Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAILY FOOD LOG - DAYS 43-45

DAY 43 Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 44 Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

DAY 45 Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

New foods tried: _____

Reactions: _____ Stool changes: _____

GAGGING vs CHOKING GUIDE

GAGGING (NORMAL - do NOT intervene):

- Baby is noisy (coughing, sputtering)
- Face may turn red briefly
- Baby can still breathe
- Baby resolves it on their own
- This is baby LEARNING to eat safely

CHOKING (EMERGENCY - act immediately):

- Baby is SILENT (no sound)
- Cannot cry or cough
- Lips/face turning blue
- Panicked look

IF CHOKING: Infant CPR (take a class BEFORE starting BLW!)

1. 5 back blows (between shoulder blades)
2. 5 chest thrusts (center of chest)
3. Alternate until object dislodges or baby goes limp
4. Call 911 if not resolved

PREVENT CHOKING:

- No round foods (cut grapes, hot dogs lengthwise)
- No hard foods (raw carrot, whole nuts)
- Always supervise
- Baby sitting upright in high chair
- No eating in car seats or while walking

IRON-RICH FOODS & MEAL PREP TIPS

IRON-RICH FOODS (essential for babies 6+ months):

- Red meat (ground beef, lamb - easiest for baby)
- Dark poultry (chicken thigh)
- Lentils and beans (mashed or whole for 9+mo)
- Tofu (cubed or strips)
- Egg yolks
- Iron-fortified cereal
- Spinach (cooked, mixed into foods)
- Chia seeds (mixed into yogurt or oatmeal)

PAIR WITH VITAMIN C for better absorption:

Strawberries, oranges, bell peppers, tomatoes, broccoli

MEAL PREP TIPS FOR BLW:

- Batch cook and freeze in portions
- Roast veggies in strips at start of week
- Keep avocados and bananas for quick meals
- Modify your dinner for baby (less salt, softer)
- Silicone ice trays = perfect portion freezing

FOODS MASTERED LIST:

WEEKLY MEAL PLAN - WEEK 1

Mon: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Tue: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Wed: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Thu: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Fri: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Sat: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Sun: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

WEEKLY MEAL PLAN - WEEK 2

Mon: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Tue: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Wed: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Thu: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Fri: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Sat: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Sun: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

WEEKLY MEAL PLAN - WEEK 3

Mon: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Tue: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Wed: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Thu: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Fri: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Sat: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Sun: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

WEEKLY MEAL PLAN - WEEK 4

Mon: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Tue: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Wed: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Thu: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Fri: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Sat: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____

Sun: B: _____ L: _____ D: _____